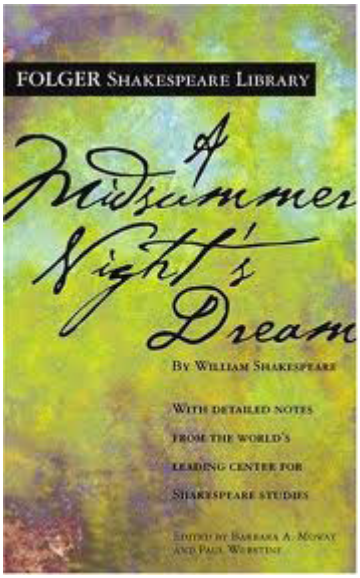
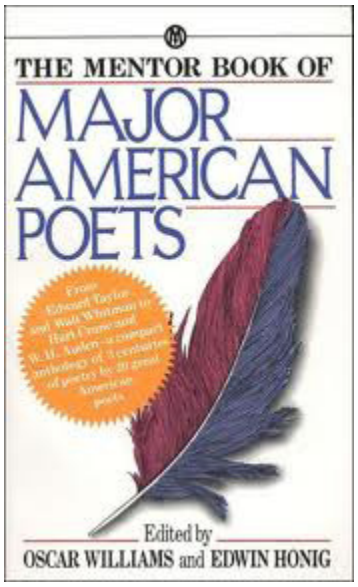
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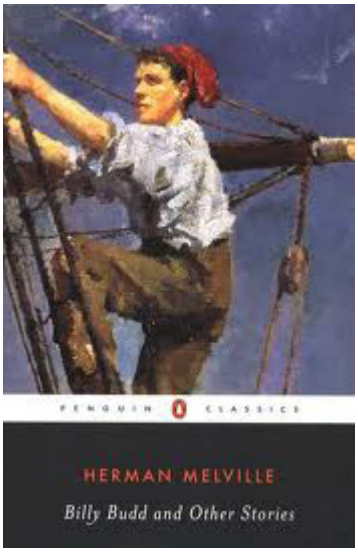
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Regional • 2012







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Region • 2012

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. Words that by their sound suggest their meaning are examples of

   A) amphigory.
   B) nonce words.
   C) nonsense verse.
   D) onomatopoeia.
   E) portmanteau words.

2. The author of an extensive body of confessional poetry and recipient of the 1967 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for her collection entitled *Live or Die* is

   A) Rita Dove.
   B) Claudia Emerson.
   C) Mary Oliver.
   D) Sylvia Plath.
   E) Anne Sexton.

3. The grammatically correct construction in which one word is placed in the same grammatical relationship with two words but in quite different senses is

   A) chiasmus.
   B) oxymoron.
   C) paradox.
   D) parallelism.
   E) syllepsis.

4. The field of literary study that has emerged since about 1935 and has concentrated on the tradition represented by writers such as J. D. Salinger, Bernard Malamud, Arthur Miller, and Saul Bellow is

   A) African American Literature.
   B) Asian American Literature.
   C) Chicano American Literature.
   D) Jewish American Literature.
   E) Native American Literature.

5. The derogatory title applied by *Blackwood's Magazine* to a group of nineteenth-century British writers including William Hazlitt and John Keats because of their alleged poor taste in diction and rhyme is the

   A) Cockney School.
   B) Fleshly School of Poetry.
   C) Martian School.
   D) Satanic School.
   E) Spasmodic School.

6. A figure of speech that, through exaggeration, is used either to heighten effect or as humor is

   A) auxesis.
   B) hyperbole.
   C) litotes.
   D) meiosis.
   E) understatement.

7. **Not** among the playwrights who would have been able to enjoy a play written and directed by William Shakespeare is

   A) Ben Jonson.
   B) Thomas Kyd.
   C) Christopher Marlowe.
   D) Edmund Spenser.
   E) William Wycherley.

8. A scheme of great antiquity that divides history into a line or cycle of stages marking the chronology of human existence is known as the

   A) Five Points.
   B) Four Ages.
   C) Great Chain of Being.
   D) Seven Cardinal Virtues.
   E) Three Unities.

9. The author of *Blood Meridian, All the Pretty Horses*, *No Country for Old Men*, and *The Road*, the last of which garnered him the 2007 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, is

   A) Michael Chabon.
   B) John Cheever.
   C) Harper Lee.
   D) Cormac McCarthy.
   E) Larry McMurtry.

10. The period in English literature between the supplanting of Norman-French as the language of the English court and the appearance of definitely Modern English writings is called the

    A) Anglo-Norman Period.
    B) Caroline Period.
    C) Middle English Period.
    D) Old English Period.
    E) Renaissance Period.

11. The overweening pride or insolence that results in the misfortune of the protagonist of a tragedy is called

A) catharsis.
B) hamartia.
C) hubris.
D) nemesis.
E) peripety.

12. In a strict sense, the literary analysis practiced by John Crowe Ransom, Allan Tate, Robert Penn Warren, and Cleanth Brooks that concentrates on the work of art as an object in itself is known as

A) New Criticism.
B) New Formalism.
C) New Historicism.
D) New Humanism.
E) New Journalism.

13. The twentieth-century American author of *One of Ours*, *O Pioneers!*, *My Ántonia*, and *Death Comes to the Archbishop* is

A) Willa Cather.
B) Kate Chopin.
C) Toni Morrison.
D) Joyce Carol Oates.
E) Flannery O'Connor.

14. A term applied to couplets, usually hexameters or longer, in which the words preceding the caesuras rhyme, and sometimes to quatrains having an *abab* pattern, is

A) chiasmus.
B) crossed rhyme.
C) leonine rhyme.
D) macaronic rhyme.
E) wrenched rhyme.

15. The group of Elizabethan dramatists, poets, scholars, and nobility who studied natural sciences, philosophy, and religion and whose members were suspected of being atheists is

A) the Della Cruscans.
B) the Fugitives.
C) The Movement.
D) the Parnassians.
E) the School of Night.

16. **Not** a song, formal speech, or formal composition of praise or joy is the

A) encomium.
B) eulogy.
C) jeremiad.
D) paean.
E) panegyric.

17. The recipient of the 1958 Pulitzer Prize for Drama and the New York Drama Critics' Circle Award for her stage adaptation of Thomas Wolfe's novel *Look Homeward, Angel* is

A) Ketti Frings.
B) Beth Henley.
C) Marsha Norman.
D) Susan-Lori Parks.
E) Paula Vogel.

18. The period between the execution of Charles I in 1649 and the restoration of the monarchy under Charles II is called the

A) Caroline Age.
B) Commonwealth Interregnum.
C) Early Tudor Age.
D) Jacobean Age.
E) Restoration Age.

19. The very recently deceased Polish poet whose tendency to make up words renders her poetry difficult to translate and for whom the 1996 Nobel Prize for Literature was "a terrible burden" is

A) Czesław Miłosz.
B) Władysław Stanisław Reymont.
C) Henryk Sienkiewicz.
D) Isaac Bashevis Singer.
E) Wislawa Szymborska.

20. The term introduced by E. M. Forster in his *Aspects of the Novel* (1927) to describe a character who is sufficiently complex to be able to surprise the reader without losing credibility is the

A) antagonist.
B) flat character.
C) protagonist.
D) round character.
E) stock character.

21. The vision of freedom, success, wealth, and fulfillment that, positively or ironically, is to some extent thematic in writings as diverse as Fitzgerald's *Great Gatsby* and *The Autobiography of Benjamin Franklin* is known as

A) The American Dream.
B) Arcadia.
C) Brooke Farm.
D) *Ultima Thule*.
E) Utopia.

22. The general environment in which a literary or artistic work is written and produced is its

A) framework-story.
B) locale.
C) milieu.
D) *mise en scène*.
E) setting.

23. The style of comic book or graphic novel that, since around 1952, typically presents in book form a story of fantasy, science fiction, or romance is the

A) anime.
B) kabuki.
C) katauta.
D) manga.
E) tanka.

24. **Not** among the twentieth-century American novelist William Faulkner's many novels is

A) *Absalom, Absalom!*
B) *The Catcher in the Rye*.
C) *Go Down, Moses*.
D) *Light in August*.
E) *The Sound and the Fury*.

25. The form of the apprenticeship novel in which the protagonist is an artist struggling from childhood to maturity toward an understanding of his or her creative mission is the

A) campus novel.
B) education novel.
C) *Kűnstlerroman*.
D) novel of manners.
E) *roman à clef*.

26. The period between the formation of the U.S. national government and the "Second Revolution" of Jacksonian Democracy during which the United States emerged as a world force and enjoyed a rapid literary development is the

A) Colonial Period.
B) Federalist Age.
C) Realistic Age.
D) Revolutionary Age.
E) Romantic Period.

27. The request or query that is addressed to the Muse at the beginning of an epic is an

A) epic formula.
B) epic question.
C) epic simile.
D) epiclesis.
E) epiphany.

28. The author of the trilogy *The Awakening Land*, of which the final novel, *The Town*, earned him the 1951 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, is

A) Saul Bellow.
B) Richard Ford.
C) Norman Mailer.
D) Conrad Richter.
E) John Updike.

29. Any poorly executed attempt at poetry, or, especially, rude verse is called

A) autotelic poetry.
B) clerihew.
C) doggerel.
D) lampoon.
E) limerick.

30. The group of American writers of the 1950s and the 1960s in rebellion against what they conceived of as the failures of American culture is the

A) Agrarians.
B) Beat Generation.
C) Fugitives.
D) Lollards.
E) Muckrakers.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-37 are associated with William Shakespeare's *A Midsummer Night's Dream*.
Items 38-44 are associated with Herman Melville's *Billy Budd, Sailor, An Inside Narrative*.
Items 45-50 are associated with Marianne Moore's poetry (selected).

31. In Shakespeare's *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, the lines "One turf shall serve as pillow for us both; / One heart, one bed, two bosoms, and one troth" are spoken by
    A) Demetrius and rebuffed by Hermia.
    B) Demetrius and welcomed by Helena.
    C) Lysander and rebuffed by Hermia.
    D) Lysander and welcomed by Hermia.
    E) Pyramus and welcomed by Thisbe.

32. The conflicts and tensions and oppositions of *MND* are resolved at the end of
    A) Act 1.
    B) Act 2.
    C) Act 3.
    D) Act 4.
    E) Act 5.

33. The accusatory lines "So should the murdered look, and so should I, / Pierced through the heart with your stern cruelty. / Yet you, the murderer, look as bright, as clear, / As yonder Venus in her glimmering sphere" are delivered by
    A) Demetrius to Helena.
    B) Demetrius to Hermia.
    C) Lysander to Egeus.
    D) Oberon to Titania.
    E) Pyramus to the lion.

34. The role of patriarchy in *MND* is expressed in the lines "I beg the ancient privilege of Athens: / As she is mine, I may dispose of her [. . .]," spoken by
    A) Demetrius.
    B) Egeus.
    C) Lysander.
    D) Oberon.
    E) Theseus.

35. Thematically, *A Midsummer Night's Dream* focuses, in part, on
    A) ambition.
    B) corruption.
    C) madness.
    D) revenge.
    E) transformation.

36. Hermia's promise to Lysander, "I swear to thee [. . .] / And by that fire which burned the Carthage queen / When the false Trojan under sail was seen [. . .]," is both a(n)
    A) allusion and an anachronism.
    B) archaism and a prolepsis.
    C) flyting and an allusion.
    D) flyting and an anachronism.
    E) hyperbole and a paradox.

37. Titania's remark that the "summer still doth tend upon my state" is a comment upon her own
    A) beauty.
    B) naiveté.
    C) obstinacy.
    D) supernatural nature.
    E) susceptibility.

38. In Melville's *Billy Budd*, the narrator's description of the battle lanterns, which are "[f]ed with oil supplied by the war contractors (whose gains, honest or otherwise, are in every land an anticipated portion of the harvest of death)," suggests his
    A) admiration for opportunists.
    B) appreciation for entrepreneurs.
    C) respect for war contractors.
    D) scorn for warmongers.
    E) unreserved xenophobia.

39. Vere's assurance to the members of the drumhead court regarding a "court more merciful than a martial one," specifically "the Last Assizes," is a(n)
    A) allusion.
    B) exegesis.
    C) prolepsis.
    D) quip.
    E) tautology.

40. The narrator's simile "[i]t was like handling a dead snake" refers specifically to
    A) the afterguardsman's reaction to being flogged.
    B) the bluejackets' attempt to secure loose rigging.
    C) the powder-boys' attempt to secure loose cannons.
    D) the removal of Billy's body from the noose.
    E) Vere and Billy's handling of Claggart's body.

41. The contrasts between Admiral Nelson and Captain Vere, between John Claggart and Billy Budd, between the type "Handsome Sailor" and Billy, and between the Dansker and Vere define the role of

A) antagonist.
B) deuteragonist.
C) foil.
D) nemesis.
E) protagonist.

42. In addition to being a dramatic literary work, Melville's *Billy Budd* can be recognized as profoundly

A) historical.
B) philosophical.
C) political.
D) satirical.
E) theological.

43. The narrator's assessment that "Truth uncompromisingly told will always have its ragged edges" addresses

A) Billy's testimony to the drumhead court.
B) Claggart's account of Billy's actions.
C) the Dansker's advice to Billy.
D) Graveling's attempt to hide Billy from impressment.
E) the narrator's recounting of Billy's story.

44. The narrator's prose style is punctuated with a form of understatement in which a thing is affirmed by stating the negative of its opposite, for example, "not without stammering" and "it was not unreasonable," which are examples of

A) apostrophe.
B) hypallage.
C) hyperbole.
D) litotes.
E) simile.

Items 45-50 refer to Marianne Moore's

In Distrust of Merits

Strengthened to live, strengthened to die for
medals and positioned victories?
They're fighting, fighting, fighting the blind
man who thinks he sees—
who cannot see that the enslaver is
enslaved; the hater, harmed. O shining O
firm star, O tumultuous
ocean lashed till small things go
as they will, the mountainous
wave makes us who look, know
depth. Lost at sea before they fought! O
star of David, star of Bethlehem,
O black imperial lion
of the Lord—emblem
of a risen world—be joined at last, be
joined. There is hate's crown beneath which all is
death; there's love's without which none
is king; the blessed deeds bless
the halo. As contagion
of sickness makes sickness,

contagion of trust can make trust. They're
fighting in deserts and caves, one by
one, in battalions and squadrons;
they're fighting that I
may yet recover from the disease, My
Self; some have it lightly; some will die. "Man's
wolf to man" and we devour
ourselves. The enemy could not
have made a greater breach in our
defenses. One pilot-

ing a blind man can escape him, but
Job disheartened by false comfort knew
that nothing can be so defeating
as a blind man who
can see. O alive who are dead, who are
proud not to see, O small dust of the earth
that walks so arrogantly,
trust begets power and faith is
an affectionate thing. We
vow, we make this promise

to the fighting—it's a promise—"We'll
never hate black, white, red, yellow, Jew,
Gentile, Untouchable." We are
not competent to
make our vows. With set jaw they are fighting,
fighting, fighting,—some we love whom we know,
some we love but know not—that
hearts may feel and not be numb.
It cures me; or I am what
I can't believe in? Some

in snow, some on crags, some in quicksands,
little by little, much by much, they
are fighting fighting fighting that where
there was death there may
be life. "When a man is prey to anger,
he is moved by outside things; when he holds
his ground in patience patience
patience, that is action or
beauty," the soldier's defense
and hardest armor for

(In Distrust of Merits)

continued

the fight. The world's an orphans' home. Shall
we never have peace without sorrow?
without pleas of the dying for
help that won't come? O
quiet form upon the dust, I cannot
look and yet I must. If these great patient
dyings—all these agonies
and wound-bearings and bloodshed—
can teach us how to live, these
dyings were not wasted.

Hate-hardened heart, O heart of iron
iron is iron till it is rust.
There never was a war that was
not inward; I must
fight till I have conquered in myself what
causes war, but I would not believe it.
I inwardly did nothing.
O Iscariot-like crime!
Beauty is everlasting
and dust is for a time.

45. The strength of lines 5-6 of Moore's most famous antiwar poem "In Distrust of Merits" depends on a(n)
A) allusion.
B) barbarism.
C) hyperbole.
D) oxymoron.
E) paradox.

46. Line 12's metonymic use of "star of David" and "star of Bethlehem" reminds the reader that Moore's poem speaks in specific terms about
A) the Arab-Israeli War.
B) the First Jewish-Roman War.
C) the Six-Day War.
D) World War I.
E) World War II.

47. The phrases "the enslaver is / enslaved" (lines 5-6) and "the blessed deeds bless the halo" (lines 18-19) are characterized by
A) amphiboly.
B) internal rhyme.
C) literation.
D) polyptoton.
E) reification.

48. Understanding "My / Self" (lines 25-26) as the disease, which is reinforced in lines 73-74, reminds us that terrible things grow from
A) bloodshed.
B) disease.
C) prejudice.
D) slavery.
E) wounds.

49. Line 78's simile is based on an allusion to the
A) Babylonian mythology.
B) Greek mythology.
C) Hebrew Bible.
D) New Testament.
E) Roman mythology.

50. Lines 65-70, taken together, focus on
A) dead bodies.
B) gruesome bloodshed.
C) hearts of iron.
D) unnecessary dying.
E) worthy sacrifice.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-52 refer to Thomas Hardy's

The Puzzled Game-Birds*

They are not those who used to feed us
When we were young—they cannot be—
These shapes that now bereave and bleed us?
They are not those who used to feed us,—
For would they not fair terms concede us?
—If hearts can house such treachery
They are not those who used to feed us
When we were young—they cannot be!

***birds that are hunted for sport**

51. The underlying concern addressed by the game-birds' collective voice in Thomas Hardy's "The Puzzled Game-Birds" is
A) betrayal.
B) concession.
C) confusion.
D) hunger.
E) youth.

52. The poetic form of Hardy's short poem is the

A) ballad.
B) cinquain.
C) lay.
D) rondel.
E) triolet.

Items 53-57 refer to William Shakespeare's

Sonnet 93

So shall I live, supposing thou art true,
Like a deceived husband; so love's face
May still seem love to me, though alter'd new:
Thy looks with me, thy heart in other place.
For there can live no hatred in thine eye,
Therefore in that I cannot know thy change;
In many's looks the false heart's history
Is writ in moods and frowns and wrinkles strange,
But heaven in thy creation did decree
That in thy face sweet love should ever dwell;
Whate'er thy thoughts or thy heart's workings be,
Thy looks should nothing thence but sweetness tell.
How like Eve's apple doth thy beauty grow,
If thy sweet virtue answer not thy show!

53. The central concern of William Shakespeare's Sonnet 93 is the difference between

A) appearances and reality.
B) a heart's history and true art.
C) heaven and sweet love.
D) smiles and frowns.
E) wives and husbands.

54. For his own inability to discover his love's "thoughts" or "heart's workings," the poem's persona blames

A) deceived husbands.
B) Eve's apple.
C) heaven.
D) moodiness.
E) sweet virtue.

55. The allusion to Eve in the sonnet's couplet is, in a sense, foreshadowed in

A) line 7.
B) line 9.
C) line 10.
D) line 11.
E) line 12.

56. The "other place" (line 4) is a different

A) person.
B) sonnet.
C) town.
D) truth.
E) universe.

57. The persona's attitude, thus the tone of the sonnet, is one of

A) admiration.
B) contempt.
C) optimism.
D) resignation.
E) satisfaction.

Items 58-61 refer to John Ciardi's

Most Like an Arch This Marriage

Most like an arch—an entrance which upholds
and shores the stone-crush up the air like lace.
Mass made idea, and idea held in place.
A lock in time. Inside half-heaven unfolds.

Most like an arch—two weaknesses that lean
into a strength. Two fallings become firm.
Two joined abeyances become a term
naming the fact that teaches fact to mean.

Not quite that? Not much less. World as it is,
what's strong and separate falters. All I do
at piling stone on stone apart from you
is roofless around nothing. Till we kiss

I am no more than upright and unset.
It is by falling in and in we make
the all-bearing point, for one another's sake,
in faultless failing, raised by our own weight.

58. John Ciardi's "Most Like an Arch This Marriage" builds on an elaborate analogy known as a

A) conceit.
B) hyperbole.
C) kenning.
D) metaphor.
E) simile.

59. The "half-heaven" unfolding in line 4 is the figurative creation of

A) an arch archetype.
B) an eclipse.
C) marital bliss.
D) purgatory.
E) shores of lace-like crushed stone.

60. The continuation of the sense and grammatical construction of line 12 through to line 13 constitutes

A) enjambment.
B) inversion.
C) metathesis.
D) parenthesis.
E) verse paragraph.

61. Line 16 of Ciardi's poem sums up the couple's interdependence through the figure of speech

A) alliteration.
B) hyperbole.
C) paradox.
D) synecdoche.
E) zeugma.

Items 62-65 refer to Claude McKay's

America

Although she feeds me bread of bitterness,
And sinks into my throat her tiger's tooth,
Stealing my breath of life, I will confess
I love this cultured hell that tests my youth!
Her vigor flows like tides into my blood,
Giving me strength erect against her hate.
Her bigness sweeps my being like a flood.
Yet as a rebel fronts a king in state,
I stand within her walls with not a shred
Of terror, malice, not a word of jeer.
Darkly I gaze into the days ahead,
And see her might and granite wonders there,
Beneath the touch of Time's unerring hand,
Like priceless treasures sinking in the sand.

62. The dominant figure of speech throughout Claude McKay's "America" is

A) apostrophe.
B) metonymy.
C) mimesis.
D) personification.
E) synaesthesia.

63. Uncharacteristically, the poem's volta occurs at the beginning of

A) line 5.
B) line 8.
C) line 9.
D) line 10.
E) line 13.

64. The phrase "cultured hell" is

A) didactic.
B) eponymic.
C) oxymoronic.
D) paradoxical.
E) rhopalic.

65. Claude McKay's "America" is a

A) fourteener.
B) Miltonic sonnet.
C) Petrarchan sonnet.
D) Shakespearean sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

Tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Robert Francis's "Catch," and compose an essay addressing the poem's base analogy.

Catch

Two boys uncoached are tossing a poem together,
Overhand, underhand, backhand, sleight of hand, everyhand,
Teasing with attitudes, latitudes, interludes, altitudes,
High, make him fly off the ground for it, low, make him stoop,
Make him scoop it up, make him as-almost-as possible miss it,
Fast, let him sting from it, now, now fool him slowly,
Anything, everything tricky, risky, nonchalant,
Anything under the sun to outwit the prosy,
Over the tree and the long sweet cadence down,
Over his head, make him scramble to pick up the meaning,
And now, like a posy, a pretty one plump in his hands.

Robert Francis

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Literary Criticism Contest
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KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 11e, the Penguin 1986 edition of *Budd*, and the Folger edition of *MND*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1.	D	384	11.	C	275	21.	A	20
2.	E	663	12.	A	368	22.	C	346
3.	E	538	13.	A	633+	23.	D	330
4.	D	302	14.	B	142	24.	B	641
5.	A	108	15.	E	497	25.	C	308
6.	B	279	16.	C	301	26.	B	225
7.	E	468	17.	A	664	27.	B	202
8.	B	239	18.	B	117	28.	D	660
9.	D	661	19.	E	659	29.	C	171
10.	C	345	20.	D	487	30.	B	59

Part 2: UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

31.	C	2.2.47-48	38.	D	370	45.	E	398
32.	D		39.	A	363	46.	E	
33.	B	3.2.60-63	40.	E	350	47.	D	428
34.	B	1.1.42-43	41.	C	232	48.	C	
35.	E		42.	B		49.	D	
36.	A	1.1.172-77	43.	E		50.	E	
37.	A	3.1.157	44.	D	317			

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism **15 items (2 points each)**

51.	A		56.	A		61.	C	398
52.	E	561	57.	D		62.	D	412
53.	A		58.	A	120	63.	B	
54.	C		59.	C		64.	C	392
55.	B		60.	A	199	65.	D	510

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Robert Francis's "Catch"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of this poem include

alliteration,
analogy,
anaphora,
connotation,
controlling image,
denotation,
explication,
free verse,
imagery,
internal rhyme,
metaphor, extended metaphor,
meter,
onomatopoeia,
pun,
tenor and vehicle,
simile,
tone,
vehicle, and
word choice.

The contestant should choose to focus on the metaphor (or the controlling image) that is the poem's analogy. He or she might recognize in the metaphor the growing complexity and the intensification of a game of catch, which is the metaphor's vehicle. The increasing complexity that often characterizes a game of catch, which is essentially a practice session for a ballgame (the game is not specifically named), should be addressed as characterizing a student's, or more generally, a person's coming to know, to understand, a poem—a poem, poetry, being the tenor of the metaphor.

The young lit critter might catch the word *uncoached*, which should suggest that there is a naturalness involved in the experiencing of a poem—that, with practice, with exposure, comes understanding.

The crescendo from the ease of "tossing a poem" to the difficulty of "anything under the sun" the student should understand as a growing through experience so that, in time, with practice, the reader of a poem can explicate poetry, can catch the meaning of a difficult poem, a complex poem, as if the meaning were to be grasped like "a pretty one plump in [one's] hands."